

PEGASUS

THE WINGED HORSE

ONE OF THE ORIGINAL 48 GREEK CONSTELLATIONS, PEGASUS REPRESENTS THE FLYING HORSE RIDDEN BY BELLEROPHON. THE GREAT SQUARE OF PEGASUS IS FORMED OF STARS IN THE HORSE'S BODY.

Pegasus is the seventh-largest constellation and occupies an area of the sky to the north of Aquarius and Pisces. It represents the head and forequarters of the flying horse. The bright stars Markab, Scheat, and Algenib mark three of the four corners of the Great Square of Pegasus. A star in the neighboring constellation of Andromeda completes it.

KEY DATA

Size ranking 7

Brightest stars Scheat (β)
2.3–2.7, Enif (ϵ) 2.4

Genitive Pegasi

Abbreviation Peg

Highest in sky at 10pm
September–October

Fully visible 90°N–53°S



CHART 3

MAIN STARS

Markab Alpha (α) Pegasi
Blue-white giant

☼ 2.5 ↔ 133 light-years

Scheat Beta (β) Pegasi

Red giant with variable brightness

☼ 2.3–2.7 ↔ 196 light-years

Algenib Gamma (γ) Pegasi

Blue-white subgiant

☼ 2.8 ↔ 391 light-years

Enif Epsilon (ϵ) Pegasi

Orange-yellow supergiant

☼ 2.4 ↔ 121 light-years

Matar Eta (η) Pegasi

Binary star

☼ 3.0 ↔ 214 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M15

Globular cluster

NGC 7331

Spiral galaxy

Stephan's Quintet

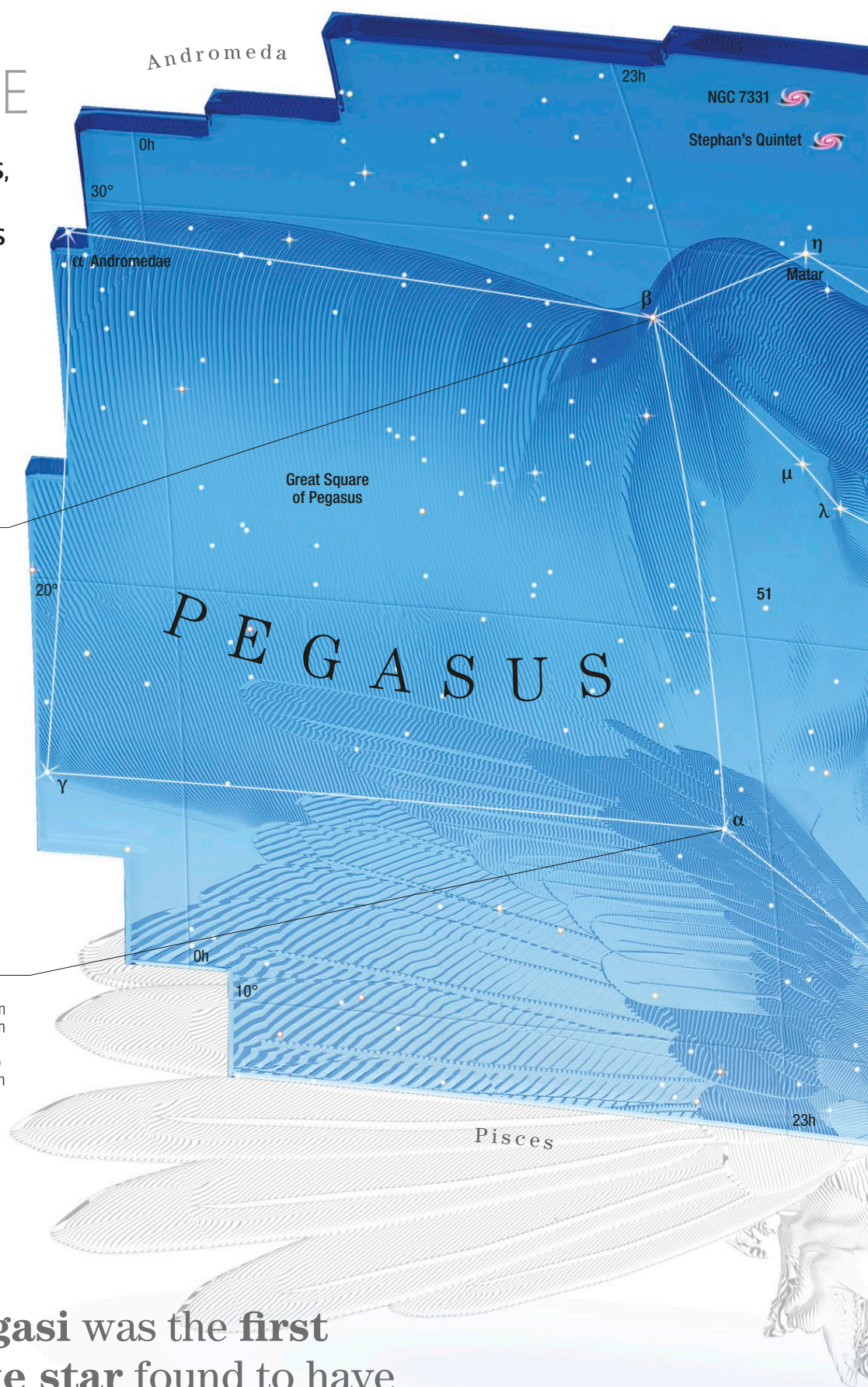
Group of five galaxies

Scheat (β Pegasi)

This red giant's coloring makes it easily distinguishable from the other stars in the Great Square

Markab (α Pegasi)

Despite its designation of Alpha Pegasi, which suggests that it is the brightest star, Markab is the third brightest in the constellation



51 Pegasi was the first sunlike star found to have an exoplanet